

Take my CDs

Hello Digit,
I have 30 to 35 Digit CDs in good condition. I format my PC once in a while, and install some utilities from the latest CD. I don't know how to utilize all these CDs. One of my friends just disposes the CDs after a month, but I don't feel like doing that. I have tried to exchange them, but my friends are regular readers of Digit too. Can you tell me what to do with my CDs?

Raman Garg
Via e-mail



ILLUSTRATOR: Mahesh Benkar

Dear Raman,
That's a problem that never occurred to us! We are sure many readers would have gaps in their CD collections that you could help fill. The best avenue for this right now is the thinkdigit.com forums where you could post a message and give the CDs to interested readers.

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Registry hacks

Dear Sumod,
Your booklet on Q&A was simply superb. What I have noticed is that the best way of getting rid of a problem is tweaking the registry. This subtle art is known by a very few. So how about an issue on Windows Registry?
Secondly, A-list is very useful, but limited. All you do is let us know about the best! We need to know about every-thing. So how about listing categories, and the listing all the products available in the market?

Ashish Kalantri
Via e-mail

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Dear Ashish,
The A-List is reserved for products that we can unreservedly say are the best available in their category. We cannot hope to list every product available in the market, which would fill entire books, in one or two pages.

Directly editing the registry is a powerful and dangerous tool. We have suggested solutions and tweaks that involve editing the registry, but it is important to exercise caution when delving into critical system areas. We will look at covering the more interesting registry hacks soon.

AMD adorer

I was horrified to see the front page of the October 2003 edition commenting "Athlon FX 64 performance champion, or still second best". You never gave the hardware specifications for the Athlon FX 51—no motherboard was mentioned, nor the chipset. According to you, AMD has a 400 MHz quad-pumped FSB, compared to 200 MHz in Intel 3.2 GHz. It supports 64-bit cinematic games, while your Gigahertz monster is going to fail in 18 months. AMD killed Intel in almost every game, P4 failed even in *Quake III*. The term 'cinematic experience' comes from AMD. Even if you boast and recommend your fake Gigahertz monster, your readers know the truth. It is just a matter of time that costly and non-upgradeable Intel processors are thrown out of the market.

Venkatraman
Via e-mail

Dear Venkatraman,
The processor was tested with an nForce3 motherboard, 512 MB DDR 400 RAM and a GeForce FX 5900 Ultra video card. The processor specifications are indeed impressive, but the performance numbers speak for themselves. While the Athlon may eventually enable cinematic experience when 64-bit games are released, its current performance with 32-bit tasks is not conclusively superior. Of course, these are early tests with software that is not optimised to handle the new processor as we said in the review, but these are the software the processor will have to deal with for the time being. We intend to revisit these tests when more 64-bit software becomes available.

In our recommended PC configurations in this issue, you may notice that we recommend Athlon because they are great value for money. However for now, the Pentium 4 3.2 GHz will continue to remain on top of our performance charts.

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Grateful about RAM

Dear Sumod

I happen to be a dealer of assembled PCs in Baroda. In your August issue, Agent 001 talks about branded memory from Corsair and Crucial. This was good news, as I have always wanted to give my customers good quality RAM. You also mentioned that a lifetime warranty is valid for 5 years, and not 3 years. In India, people do not give attention to the quality or quantity of RAM; even branded PCs bundle only a pathetic 128 MB RAM with their 2.4 GHz machines. It's like giving Ferrari cars tyres rated 4,170 Km/h to machines capable of only 300 Km/h. I do hope to see more interesting articles from you to help people buy better products.

Sundeep Govindan
Via e-mail

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Dear Sundeep,
Balancing the budget across the key sub-systems in a PC is a fine art, and RAM seems to be the most overlooked component. As you rightly point out, 128 MB is fine for Windows 98 users, but any desktop version of Windows or Linux released in the last two years would perform much better with a little more. It's not just branded PC makers, even assemblers hinder their computer's performance with high speed processors and slow everything else. It's great to see an aware assembler for a change. Keep up the good work!

digit READERPOLLS

Your vote counts

This month's question:

Question: How do you get your music?

- ☐ Buy original cassettes and CDs
- ☐ Download MP3s

- ☐ Borrow or record from friends
- ☐ Don't listen to music much

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote